Good morning, Commissioners. My name is Augustus Chell, a resident of Williamsburg. The three-page handout on your desks is for your immediate reference while I speak, while the complete seven-page brief has been submitted to the Clerk to be entered into the permanent public record for your later perusal.

I am standing before you today to address a critical vulnerability in how Antrim County's public assets and administrative labor are being utilized. Right now, private technology vendors are bypassing this Commission's centralized legislative oversight. By executing fragmented, township-by-township contracts—such as the July 2026 Forest Home agreement—these corporations are expanding an intrusive digital surveillance network across this region. These independent township cameras do not operate in a vacuum; they rely on an unvoted backdoor subsidy from this county, leveraging local county-funded dispatch, servers, and terminals to process private alerts while taxpayers foot the bill. **Not only are Antrim taxpayers paying the hidden operational cost, but they're doing so whilst critical local infrastructure sits broken.** This past June, severe flash flooding triggered devastating stream-crossing collapses and road washouts along the vital M-88 and M-66 corridors. Also, as residents rightfully pointed out during public comment at the last meeting, we see this exact problem on Lakeshore Drive, where subsurface drainage failures remain completely unaddressed. Taxpayer funds must be preserved for physical concrete, steel, and pavement right here in Northern Michigan soil, rather than being redirected to cross-subsidize out-of-state technology subscriptions.

I am not here to hand you a grievance; ***I'd like to thank Dr. Distin and his team of patriots, along with all of the community members who stood up for freedom,*** for sharing our concerns. I am handing you an actionable legislative solution. I have distributed a 3-page Executive Handout and a complete 7-page Legislative Brief to you and the Clerk.

To avoid the constitutional trap of micromanaging an elected Sheriff's law enforcement duties, this framework relies entirely on your undisputed statutory power over county property under MCL 46.11, sub-section l. Proposed Action 1 does not dictate deputy behavior; it directs the county's civilian IT Department to permanently scrub all proprietary vendor access keys and data tokens from county-owned devices.

To ensure this policy is explicitly established within both the video broadcast and the official public record, I am now reading the core mandate of the Mandatory Budgetary Rider from page 5 of my brief:

First: No public revenues—including federal, state, or private grants—shall be expended to purchase, lease, or maintain software subscriptions or APIs managed by third-party ALPR vendors, specifically including Flock Safety.

Second: Pursuant to this Board's exclusive authority over county property under MCL 46.11, the Antrim County IT Department is directly ordered to audit all county-funded mobile terminals, workstations, and computing property.

Third: They must permanently remove and prohibit all proprietary software interfaces, browser shortcuts, or database access tokens linked to these third-party surveillance networks.

This brief includes a strict exception protocol for state-validated AMBER Alerts, ensuring public safety is never compromised.

As a proud resident of Michigan House District 104 who believes in our nation's sacred promise of liberty and justice for all, I ask this Board to formally refer this package to Civil Counsel for immediate adoption. I am entering this complete package into the public record with the County Clerk. Thank you.